

Aaron Scherf

WORK EXPERIENCE

U.S. Agency for International Development

06/2020 – 07/2025

Foreign Service Officer – Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning Team Lead (FS 3–5)

Kyiv, Ukraine

- Managed portfolio of 20 program evaluations, including leading design of a \$1.5M randomized control trial to evaluate impact and cost effectiveness of \$450M credit facilitation program for small farmers.
- Developed country research plan and designed 12 context assessments, covering gender and ethnic minority inclusion, environmental analysis, business financing, and agricultural exports.
- Developed analytics system to track \$5Bn in electrical infrastructure support by administrative geography, enabling rapid repairs in response to Russian missile strikes and increased accountability.

Foreign Service Officer – Gender Equity and Program Design Officer (FS 4–9) **Bogota, Colombia**

- Led the design and context research for four programs in smallholder agriculture, environmental conservation, rural land titling, and indigenous civic society leadership.
- Developed system to process high-resolution drone imagery for land titling in flood-prone rural areas.

Foreign Service Officer – Program Officer Rotations (FS 5–12)

Washington, DC, USA

- Won agency-wide award for developing new budget data processing and visualization tool using Python and Tableau, saving hundreds of hours of staff time in negotiations with State Department.
- Led knowledge management pilot program with South Sudan office, including designing staff transition resources and implementation plan for improving handovers and file management in Juba.

University of California, Berkeley

08/2018 – 05/2020

Graduate Student Instructor

Berkeley, CA, USA

- MATH 10A – Methods of Mathematics: Calculus, Linear Algebra, and Combinatorics: Independently taught 52 pre-med students across two seminars and office hours, including quiz design and grading.
- PP 297 – Stata for Public Policy Analysis: Designed and taught empirical research methods in Stata seminar for 40 MPP and MPA students, including research support for capstone projects.
- DATA 100 – Principles and Techniques of Data Science: Developed and taught labs on intermediate data science techniques in Python for undergraduates, including office hours and project support.
- DS 421 – Data Science Applications for Environmental Science: Coached team of 4 doctoral students on data science research projects on forest management practices for post-fire vegetation recovery

Berkeley Food Institute

09/2019 – 03/2020

Agriculture and Hydrology Research Analyst

Berkeley, CA, USA

- Developed geospatial model analyzing groundwater and rainfall data compared with agricultural land-use for California's Central Valley, to support legislative reform and efficient water management.

Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW)

11/2017 – 07/2018

Graduate Research Fellow – Migration and Labor Economics

Mannheim, Germany

- Analyzed panel data to model effects of asylum seekers' education level and living conditions on employment outcomes using GMM and instrumental variable methods in Stata.
- Co-authored research paper in German on refugee integration strategies in Rhine-Neckar region for presentation to city councils in Heidelberg and Mannheim.

U.S. House of Representatives

05/2017 – 08/2017

Policy Analyst – Congressman Crowley and House Democratic Caucus

Washington, DC, USA

- Created financial model to analyze differential impacts by age bracket of proposed retirement savings bill, to prepare Democratic Caucus members for debate.
- Wrote 6 briefings on policy issues for review by the representative, discussing new sanctions on Russia and the Technology Modernization Fund.

EDUCATION

Georgia Institute of Technology

Master of Science in Computer Science • GPA: 3.88

Atlanta, GA, USA • 01/2022 – 12/2025

Indiana State University

Master of Science in Mathematics • GPA: 3.85

Terre Haute, IN, USA • 05/2021 – 05/2024

Thesis: Novel Omnibus Normality Test and Power Comparison with the Shapiro-Wilk

University of California, Berkeley

Master of Science in Development Practice • GPA: 3.94

Berkeley, CA, USA • 07/2018 – 05/2020

Thesis: Predicting the Yield of CIMMYT Wheat Genotypes via Remote Sensing and Machine Learning

Heidelberg University

Master of Science (audited) in Economics

Heidelberg, DE • 07/2017 – 06/2018

Mercer University

Bachelor in Finance and Economics • GPA: 3.91

Macon, GA, USA • 08/2013 – 05/2017

AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

Donald M. Payne Fellow (\$100,000 fellowship with USAID)

05/2017

Fulbright Scholar (Research Fellow at ZEW / Heidelberg, DE)

05/2017

Humanity in Action Senior Fellow (in partnership with Amnesty International)

05/2017

Stamps Foundation Leadership Scholar (\$240,000 merit scholarship)

05/2013

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS & PUBLICATIONS

Applications of PCA for Mapping Regional Socioeconomic Vulnerability Indices

12/2019

UC Berkeley: Data for Human Mobility Lab

Integration Progress: Results from two Reallabor Surveys of Asylum Seekers

08/2018

Centre for European Economic Research (ZEW)

Published at: <https://www.econstor.eu/handle/10419/231442>

Gentrification or Revitalization? Ethical Investment in Urban Property Development

04/2017

National Conference on Undergraduate Research

Economic Impact Assessment of Historic Property Rehabilitation in Macon, GA

04/2017

Society of Business, Industry, and Economics Conference

“OurBlock” – Blockchain Based Property Registry for South African Land Reform

03/2017

Harvard Social Entrepreneurship Pitch Competition

“How to Kill a Microfinance Fund” – Analysis of Microcredit Policy in South Africa

10/2016

Southern Conference Undergraduate Research Forum

“Bloomfield 2020” – Neighborhood Economic Development Plan

04/2016

Clinton Global Initiative University at Berkeley, CA

SKILLS

Computer Programming and Artificial Intelligence

- Python, R, JavaScript
- Stata, MatLab, Excel
- Machine Learning
- Natural Language Processing
- Artificial Neural Networks

Applied Economic Research

- GIS Analysis (ArcGIS / GEE)
- Applied Econometrics
- Mathematical Statistics
- Labor Economic Research
- Applied Mathematics
- Development Economics

Languages and Other

- Spanish – Professional
- German – Intermediate
- Program Evaluation
- Empirical Policy Analysis
- Information Communications Technology